POLICY DOCUMENT

Privacy Statement

Website, program, mentorship, volunteer, donor, and student information

Policy ID: NSF-PR-01	Status: Proposed for Board Approval
Approval / Effective Date: To be established	Policy Owner: Board of Directors / designated administrator

1. Who we are and what this statement covers

Ninjas STEM Foundation (NSF) is a Texas nonprofit educational organization. This Statement explains the categories of personal information that NSF may collect, why it uses the information, circumstances in which it may share information, and how individuals may make inquiries.

It addresses the public Foundation website and NSF's educational, outreach, volunteer, mentorship, sponsorship, and administrative activities. Separate event hosts, competition organizations, payment providers, and independently operated robotics teams may have their own privacy practices.

2. Information collected

The public contact form currently asks for a name, email address, inquiry topic/subtopic, and message. Program applications and participation records may collect parent contact details, student name and eligibility, interests, attendance, emergency contact and appropriate safety information, accepted participation terms, and educational progress.

Volunteer and mentor administration may involve contact details, role qualifications, required screening status, training completion, and assignment history. Fundraising and program administration may include donor/partner contact information, amounts, gift restrictions, acknowledgments, and transaction records.

Where separately authorized, NSF may maintain photographs, video, names approved for captions, or student-created work to document its educational programs. NSF should not request unnecessary government identifiers, medical histories, or confidential invention details through its public contact form.

3. How we receive information

Information may be received directly from a parent, guardian, adult participant, volunteer, donor, or partner; from an authorized program host or registration provider; or through ordinary use of NSF's public website and communication services.

The Foundation website is currently published through GitHub Pages and loads Google Fonts. The contact page's code currently submits messages to a FormSubmit endpoint. These descriptions reflect the reviewed website implementation and must be verified again before publishing this Statement if the website changes.

Service providers may process technical data such as IP address, browser details, timestamps, and request logs under their own practices. NSF has not independently verified every provider's precise log retention, cookie usage, or onward transfers; those details must be checked before making a more specific promise.

4. Purposes of use

- Reply to questions and coordinate requested mentorship, educational workshops, admissions, volunteer opportunities, and partnerships.
- Operate and safeguard educational activities, make enrollment and role decisions under applicable policies, and contact a parent or guardian in an emergency.
- Keep appropriate corporate, tax, donor, grant, sponsorship, accounting, and organizational records.
- Coordinate consented communications, program information, and community impact reporting.
- Comply with legal obligations, preserve evidence, respond to authorized requests, and protect NSF participants and property.

5. Children's information and parental involvement

NSF's public inquiry form requests that questions about a child be submitted by a parent or guardian. NSF does not encourage minors, especially children under 13, to submit personal information directly through the general website form.

When a minor participates, appropriate enrollment, safety, and media permissions are obtained through the responsible adult as required by the applicable policy. NSF applies reasonable child-privacy safeguards even where a particular commercial privacy statute does not apply to its nonprofit operations.

NSF shall not publish full student names, contact details, detailed health information, educational assessments, or identifiable media without an appropriate authorization and program purpose.

6. Service providers and disclosures

NSF may share necessary information with authorized volunteers and officers, service providers operating its website or communications, approved program hosts or competition administrators when reasonably required and appropriately disclosed, professional advisers, and regulators or courts where permitted or required by law.

NSF does not authorize selling children's personal information, independent sponsor reuse of student data, or behavioral advertising based on student files. A donor, sponsor, mentor, or program partner does not receive unrestricted access to participant information.

The extent of provider processing, storage locations, and terms of service are subject to NSF's actual vendor arrangements. This Statement shall be updated if additional form, donation, registration, analytics, or communications services are implemented.

7. Public media permission

Identifiable student photos, recordings, and public captions are governed by a separate optional Photo & Video Consent Policy and form. Participation is not conditioned on agreeing to optional publicity.

Where parental permission is withdrawn, NSF will stop new controlled uses and undertake the reasonable removal steps stated in the consent form, subject to distributed materials, third-party copies, and preservation obligations.

8. Information security and retention

NSF shall apply reasonable organizational safeguards appropriate to the information, including role-based access, authorized storage, appropriate credentials, and limitation of public disclosure. No online transmission or storage system can be guaranteed completely secure.

NSF retains information as needed for its stated educational and administrative purposes, the Records Management Policy, contractual commitments, and applicable legal or preservation duties. Specific records have different retention periods; a universal deletion date is not promised.

9. Requests, questions, and corrections

Parents, adult participants, donors, and other individuals may contact NSF to inquire about information NSF holds, request a correction, discuss a consent choice, or raise a privacy concern. NSF may verify identity or parental authority before providing or changing personal information and may limit a response where law, another person's privacy, privilege, or preservation obligations require.

Contact: robotexninjas@gmail.com or the Foundation contact page at https://sunke530-dev.github.io/robotexninjas/foundation-contact.html. These contact details should be confirmed by the Board as the official privacy contact before publication.

10. External sites and changes

Links to external hosts, payment, video, social-media, and registration sites are subject to those third parties' policies. This Statement does not make NSF responsible for practices outside its control.

NSF may update this Statement prospectively. The public copy shall show its effective date and material changes when approved. An earlier privacy obligation or lawful access right is not waived merely by publication of a revised statement.

Source and implementation notes (non-operative)

The following references informed the draft. They do not establish that this policy has been adopted, that every clause is legally mandatory, or that existing governance questions are resolved. Confirm against the documents and law controlling when NSF adopts the policy.

- NSF GitHub website reviewed: foundation-contact.html and scripts.js (FormSubmit endpoint), Foundation page Google Fonts and GitHub Pages hosting; current code is subject to change.
- FTC COPPA FAQ concerning nonprofit entities and recommended child privacy practices: https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/complying-coppa-frequently-asked-questions
- Texas AG: Texas Data Privacy and Security Act nonprofit exemption, subject to actual organizational status and other applicable law: https://www.texasattorneygeneral.gov/consumer-protection/file-consumer-complaint/consumer-privacy-rights/texas-data-privacy-and-security-act
- QCRA published Privacy Statement, used as structural comparison only: https://www.queencityrobotics.org/privacy-statement
- Before publication confirm vendor disclosures, contact identity, NSF practices for media, consent, retention, access, donations, and child inquiries.